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CENTRAL CULTURAL FUND & ARCHAEOLOGICAL DEPARTMENT REGULATIONS

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1. SIGIRIYA ROCK FORTRESS

- **Operating Hours:** 6:30 AM to 5:30 PM (Ticket counter closes at 5:00 PM).

- **Ticket Rates:** Foreign Adult USD 36 (or equivalent LKR).

- **Photography & Drone Rules:**

* Photography is strictly prohibited in the Mirror Wall and Frescoes cave area. Flash photography anywhere near the frescoes is illegal.

* Commercial drone operations require clearances from the Department of Archaeology, Ministry of Defence, and CAA. Unpermitted drones will be confiscated.

- **Dress Code & Decorum:**

* Modest clothing covering shoulders and knees is mandatory.

* Playing loud music or making noise near hornets' nests on the rock face is prohibited.

- **Visitor Safety:** Hornets are present on the upper terrace. In case of hornet alerts, visitors must follow site warden instructions and cover up using protective netting provided at safety points.

2. POLONNARUWA ANCIENT CITY

- **Operating Hours:** 7:00 AM to 5:30 PM.

- **Sacred Sites (Gal Vihara, Vatadage):**

* Footwear and headwear (hats, caps) must be removed before entering sacred temple precincts.

* Turning one's back directly toward Buddha statues for photographs is considered disrespectful and prohibited.

3. TEMPLE OF THE SACRED TOOTH RELIC (SRI DALADA MALIGAWA - KANDY)

- **Operating Hours:** 5:30 AM to 8:00 PM daily. Ritual Puja Ceremonies: 5:30 AM, 9:30 AM, and 6:30 PM.

- **Ticket Rates:** Foreign Visitors LKR 2,000 (Includes entry and access to the World Buddhism Museum).

- **Dress Code & Sacred Ground Protocols:**

* Mandatory dress code: Clothing covering shoulders and knees. White or light-colored attire is preferred.

* Shoes, hats, and footwear must be removed and stored at the designated footwear counters before crossing the moat bridge.

- **Photography Directives:**

* Flash photography inside the Shrine Room and Inner Chamber is prohibited.

* Photographing people posing with their back turned directly to Buddha statues is strictly illegal.

4. DAMBULLA CAVE TEMPLE (GOLDEN TEMPLE)

- **Operating Hours:** 7:00 AM to 7:00 PM (Ticket counter at the base closes at 5:00 PM).

- **Ticket Rates:** Foreign Adult LKR 2,000. Tickets MUST be purchased at the bottom counter before climbing the rock.

- **Conservation Rules:**

* Footwear and hats must be deposited at the upper temple gate before stepping onto the sacred rock complex.

* Touching or leaning against ancient wall murals, frescoes, and rock-carved Buddha statues is strictly prohibited.

* Photography with flash inside the five cave sanctuaries is illegal to prevent pigment degradation.

5. ANURADHAPURA ANCIENT CITY (SACRED CITY)

- **Operating Hours:** 7:00 AM to 6:00 PM.

- **Sacred Sites (Jaya Sri Maha Bodhi, Ruwanwelisaya, Jetavanaramaya):**

* Strict dress code applies: Shoulders and knees must be fully covered (White attire is strongly recommended).

* Footwear and headwear must be removed before entering all stupa terraces and sacred precincts.

* Drone photography is strictly banned over the sacred zone without Defense Ministry and Archaeological Department clearance.

6. YAPAHUWA ROCK FORTRESS & ANCIENT KINGDOM

- **Operating Hours:** 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM daily.

- **Ticket Rates:** Foreign Adult LKR 1,000 (Central Cultural Fund ticket counter).

- **Dress Code & Sacred Decorum:**

* Modest dress code is strictly enforced: Shoulders and knees must be covered when ascending the ornamental staircase and entering the top temple cave.

* Footwear must be removed before stepping onto the sacred upper shrine terrace.

- **Photography & Drone Rules:**

* Photography of the iconic stone lion staircase is permitted, but posing inappropriately or sitting on stone sculptures is strictly prohibited.

* Drone operations around the rock fortress require written authorization from the Department of Archaeology and Ministry of Defence.

- **Access & Transport Regulations:**

* Parking available at the base site; inner kingdom exploration is strictly on foot via steep stone steps.

7. MIHINTALE SACRED SANCTUARY

- **Operating Hours:** 6:00 AM to 8:00 PM daily.

- **Ticket Rates:** Foreign Adult LKR 1,000.

- **Dress Code & Sacred Protocols:**

* Strictly white or light-colored clothing covering shoulders and knees is mandatory across the entire sanctuary grounds.

* Footwear and headwear (hats/caps) must be removed at the footwear counter at the base of the main granite staircase before ascending to Ambasthala and Aradhana Gala.

- **Photography Regulations:**

* Flash photography inside the ancient stupas and relic chambers is strictly banned.

* Standing with your back turned directly to Buddha statues or the main Stupa for selfies is prohibited.

- **Access & Transit Guidelines:**

* Electric golf carts and bicycles are allowed up to the middle terrace parking area; upper summit access is foot-trekking only.

8. BELIGAMMANA & LANKATILAKA / GADALADENIYA TEMPLES (KANDY)

- **Operating Hours:** 7:00 AM to 6:30 PM daily.

- **Ticket Rates:** Foreign Adult LKR 500 per temple site.

- **Dress Code & Temple Decorum:**

* Traditional modest attire required: Shoulders and legs down to ankles/knees covered.

* Shoes and footwear must be deposited at the outer temple gates before walking on the sacred stone courtyards.

- **Photography Rules:**

* Photography inside the image houses (Viharage) with flash is prohibited to preserve 14th-century wood carvings and wall paintings.

* Videography for commercial purposes requires prior approval from the Chief Incumbent and Archaeological Department.

- **Access Rules:**

* Vehicles must park in the designated lower parking lots; narrow ancient stone paths inside the temple premises are strictly pedestrian zones.

9. RITIGALA ARCHAEOLOGICAL MONASTERY RESERVE

- **Operating Hours:** 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM (Entry permits issued until 4:00 PM at Archaeological Office).

- **Ticket Rates:** Foreign Adult LKR 1,500.

- **Dress Code & Sanctuary Guidelines:**

* Visitors must dress respectfully (covered shoulders and knees) as this is a combined forest monastery and archaeological reserve.

* Running, shouting, or making loud noises along the ancient stone paved paths (Padhana Gharas) is strictly forbidden.

- **Photography & Drone Rules:**

* Commercial photography and drone usage are completely banned within the strict nature reserve boundary without special Archaeological Department clearance.

* Touching, leaning on, or walking over ancient stone ruins and medicinal baths is a punishable offense.

- **Transport & Eco-Access:**

* Vehicles permitted only up to the Forest Department ticket barrier; exploration inside the reserve is 100% walking on marked stone trails.

10. JAFFNA FORT & NALLUR KANDASWAMY KOVIL

- Operating Hours:

- * Jaffna Fort: 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM daily.
- * Nallur Kovil: 4:30 AM to 5:00 PM (Temple Puja timings: 5:00 AM, 10:00 AM, 12:00 PM, and 4:30 PM).

- Dress Code & Hindu Kovil Protocols (Nallur Kovil):

- * Male visitors must remove their shirts/upper-body clothing and shoes before entering the Kovil inner courtyard.
- * Female visitors must wear modest dresses covering shoulders and knees (Saris/Salwars preferred).

- Photography Regulations:

- * Photography and videography are strictly prohibited inside the inner Kovil sanctuary during worship ceremonies.
- * Photography inside Jaffna Fort is permitted, but commercial filming requires Defence Ministry clearance.

- Transport & Parking:

- * Tuk-tuks and bicycles are encouraged in the heritage city zone; parking is restricted outside the fort ramparts and Kovil main entrance gates.